



DAS Policy

Wireless Local Area Network

No:
2100-06

Effective:
April 29, 2025

Approval:

Katrina Flory, Assistant Director/State CIO

I. Purpose

This policy addresses the use, management, and control of IEEE 802.11 **Wireless** local area network (WLAN) protocols, commonly referred to as “Wireless” within the Ohio Department of Administrative Services (DAS). These protocols are used for connecting client devices to a data network through the use of over-the-air radio signals. This policy also defines the permitted and prohibited uses of Wireless services within DAS facilities or for DAS business use, including, but not limited to, both guest and private Wireless networks. The first occurrence of the word in the policy body outside of a title or heading is in bold, italic type, and is hyperlinked to the definition in Section IV.

II. Scope

This policy applies to all managers of DAS business units that are responsible for establishing or maintaining a DAS WLAN.

III. Policy

All WLAN technologies authorized to connect to the state’s private network shall adhere to the following configuration, implementation and management requirements:

A. Network Configuration

1. Access to state network assets from state-owned Wireless client devices shall be through **Wireless Access Points (WAPs)** in **Infrastructure Mode** only. No **Ad Hoc Mode** is permitted.
2. WAP installations shall include logically separate Wireless networks for guest and state user access each with a different and distinct broadcast identifier (Service Set Identification - SSID). The guest network shall be outside the boundary of the internal

network.

B. **Wireless Access Points (WAPs)**

1. All WAPs shall be requested and authorized by DAS Office of Information Technology (OIT) Unified Network Services (UNS). No unauthorized WAPs shall be connected to the state's network.
2. All WAPs shall be industry certified by the Wi-Fi Alliance to guarantee interoperability and enterprise-level security capabilities.
3. All WAPs shall be listed in a registry maintained by the state's Wireless access provider.
4. All default WAP names, usernames and administrator passwords shall be changed prior to installation.
5. All WAPs shall be named in a manner consistent with the naming convention developed and managed by DAS OIT UNS.
6. WAPs shall include a broadcast identifier, SSID, in a format approved by DAS OIT UNS.
7. All WAPs, included in the state's asset inventory, that are taken out of service shall be disposed of by DAS OIT UNS, as outlined in Ohio Administrative Policy IT-05, "Disposal, Servicing and Transfer of IT Equipment."
 - a) DAS OIT UNS shall ensure the removal of WAP configuration information, such as passwords; keys; names; network addresses; and other pertinent information, prior to disposal.
 - b) WAPs removed by the state's **Service Provider** are not state assets; are not capable of retaining configuration information; and are therefore, not subject to the disposal rules outlined in Ohio Administrative Policy IT-05.

C. **Wireless Client Devices**

1. All state-owned and state-authorized Wireless client devices shall be Wi-Fi Alliance certified to guarantee interoperability and enterprise-level security capabilities.
2. DAS OIT UNS shall implement controls to ensure that Wireless client devices authorized to connect to DAS networks, whether Wireless or wired networks, are configured to prevent connections from or to other Wireless client devices in ad-hoc or **Peer-to-Peer Mode**.
3. DAS OIT UNS shall implement controls to ensure that **Portable Devices** authorized to connect to DAS private Wireless networks have personal **Firewalls**, up-to-date antivirus definitions (when applicable), and security **Patches**.

D. **Network Operations**

1. The Wireless access method or protocol for communication shall be an accepted and approved industry standard mechanism as defined by IEEE.
2. All data in transit on the WLAN, that is considered **Confidential Data**, shall be encrypted in a manner consistent with Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14, "Data **Encryption** and Securing Confidential Data."
3. Access to the DAS Wireless network for state business or access to Confidential Data shall include client device and end-user authentication.
4. Authentication mechanisms or protocols selected shall be industry-accepted standards that are considered robust and reliable.
5. The DAS OIT Service Provider shall develop and implement a plan to manage radio frequencies and channels used by DAS' installed Wireless technologies.

E. **Network Management**

1. DAS Wireless networks shall be routinely scanned for rogue devices. The DAS Office of Information Security and Privacy (OISP) Security Monitoring team shall be notified when rogue devices are identified.
2. The DAS OISP Security Monitoring team shall be responsible for planning the shutdown, removal, or confiscation of unauthorized **Wireless Devices** operating within DAS facilities.
3. All WAPs and client devices shall be audited on a consistent and on-going basis for intrusion prevention and detection by DAS OIT UNS.
4. All WAPs shall be configured to send audit log information to the enterprise security information and event management (SIEM) solution.
5. Use of the DAS Wireless network shall comply with DAS Policy 700-01, "Information Technology Resource Usage."

IV. **Definitions**

- A. Ad Hoc Mode: This is a Wireless network configuration that does not use access points; **Stations** communicate directly with each other.¹
- B. Confidential Data. This classification includes Data that is required to be protected by law or regulation, is intended for confidential use, and may not be copied or removed from an agency's operational control without authorized permission. This classification includes

¹ Frankel, Shelia, Bernard Eydt, Les Owens, Karen Scarfone. "NIST Special Publication 800-97, Establishing Wireless Robust Security Networks: A Guide to IEEE 802.11i," U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, February 2007 < <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/Legacy/SP/nistspecialpublication800-97.pdf>>.

Data that, if compromised, may result in loss of life, serious injury, or other harm to an individual or group, or disruption to critical agency operations.

- C. Encryption: The use of an algorithmic process to transform data into a form in which there is a low probability of assigning meaning without use of a confidential process or key.
- D. Firewall. A device or program that controls the flow of network traffic between networks or hosts that employ differing security postures.²
- E. Infrastructure Mode. This Wireless network configuration requires access points and is the most commonly used mode for WLANs. All Stations connect with an access point, and the access point transfers frames among the Stations and the distribution system.³
- F. Patch. A procedure or software that corrects a malfunction or security vulnerability of a system.
- G. Peer-to-Peer Mode. See definition for Ad Hoc Mode.
- H. Portable Devices. Computer or device designed for mobile use. For the purposes of this policy, a portable device includes laptops, smartphones or tablets.
- I. Service Provider. For the purposes of this policy, the service provider is the vendor with whom DAS contracts to provide Wireless local area network support (e.g., design, implementation, and management). DAS OIT is also considered a WLAN service provider to other state agencies, boards, and commissions.
- J. Station. A Station is a Wireless endpoint device, such as a laptop or mobile phone. (Technically, a Station is a Wireless network interface implementation. It is distinct from the device that will provide an application using the network interface (such as a laptop or mobile phone).⁴
- K. Wireless. Use of various electromagnetic spectrum frequencies, such as radio and infrared, to communicate services, such as data and voice, without relying on a hardwired connection, such as cable or fiber optics.
- L. Wireless Access Point. A Wireless network receiver and transmitter capable of connecting multiple Wireless Stations (clients) together using 802.11 to form a Wireless local area network.
- M. Wireless Device. Any device (e.g., laptops, or desktops) with a Wireless network interface card that can connect to the state's network.

² Scarfone, Karen, Paul Hoffman. "NIST Special Publication 800-41 Revision 1, Guidelines on Firewalls and Firewall Policy, Recommendations of the National Institute of Standards and Technology," U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, September 2009 <<https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/nistpubs/800-41-Rev1/sp800-41-rev1.pdf>>.

³ Frankel, Shelia, Bernard Eydt, Les Owens, Karen Scarfone. "NIST Special Publication 800-97, Establishing Wireless Robust Security Networks: A Guide to IEEE 802.11i," U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, February 2007 <<https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/Legacy/SP/nistspecialpublication800-97.pdf>>.

⁴ Frankel, Shelia, Bernard Eydt, Les Owens, Karen Scarfone. "NIST Special Publication 800-97, Establishing Wireless Robust Security Networks: A Guide to IEEE 802.11i," U.S. Department of Commerce National Institute of Standards and Technology, February 2007 <<https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/Legacy/SP/nistspecialpublication800-97.pdf>>.

V. Authority

ORC 125.18

VI. Resources

Document Name	Location
Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)	https://www.ieee.org/
Wi-Fi Alliance	https://www.wi-fi.org/
Ohio IT Standard ITS-SEC-01 Data Encryption and Cryptography	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-04 Use of Internet, E-mail, and Other IT Resources	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-05 Disposal, Servicing and Transfer of IT Equipment	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 Data Encryption and Securing Confidential Data	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
DAS Policy 700-01 Information Technology Resource Usage	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies

VII. Inquiries

Direct inquiries about this policy to:

Office of Information Security & Privacy
Office of Information Technology
Ohio Department of Administrative Services
30 East Broad Street, 39th Floor
Columbus, Ohio 43215

614-644-6860 | state.isp@das.ohio.gov

DAS Policies may be found online at
<https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies>

VIII. Revision History

This policy shall be reviewed no less than every two years and updated as needed.

Date	Description of Change
12/01/2009	New policy for DAS, replaces OIT policy dated 11/02/07.
12/05/2012	Policy reissued under Director Robert Blair
12/21/2018	Updated the policy to align with current technology and DAS OIT's approach to the management of Wireless services.
06/10/2020	Updated the policy template to align with the current format.
06/09/2021	Conducted routine maintenance review of citations and references.
03/05/2024	Updated the policy template. Added a revision history review frequency statement.
04/29/2025	Replaced the term sensitive data, or sensitive information, with confidential data. Revised references to Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 to reflect the title change.